

CONTEXT

The European Union faces an urgent need to secure sustainable, fair and politically feasible sources of revenue to repay **NextGenerationEU (NGEU)** borrowing and finance the ambitions of the next **Multiannual Financial Framework (MFF) 2028-2034**.

While the European Commission has proposed a set of new own resources, including revenues linked to the ETS, CBAM and CORE, resistance from several Member States, combined with the requirement for unanimity in Council and subsequent national ratification, creates **a significant risk that these proposals will not be adopted in full**, on time, or at all. In the absence of new revenue streams, the financing gap is likely to be addressed through cuts to EU programmes, putting the external action's budget at high risk.

At the same time, **several alternative revenue options are already present in policy discussions**. Some have been advanced by Member States, including France, while others have been developed by researchers, think tanks and civil society actors. A number of these options appear technically credible and potentially promising, but they currently lack broad political backing.

This assignment seeks to address that gap by commissioning a report that presents and analyses some of these options.

PURPOSE OF THE ASSIGNMENT

The purpose of the assignment is to provide a practical and analytically robust **assessment of alternative, genuinely new, own resources** that could help advance the negotiations and break the deadlock in the Council.

The primary audience is policymakers and officials working on the file in the Council and Member State capitals, i.e. financial ministries and budget attachés in the Permanent Representations. **The secondary audience** is all the other actors who can influence the debate and the primary audience, including other EU institutions, national administrations, civil society, business interests, and think tanks.

The report should present solutions in an appealing way. These solutions should be politically credible and technically feasible.

STRATEGIC OBJECTIVE

The report should help shift the debate from a narrow focus on the Commission's 2025 ORD proposal towards a broader set of options that may be more effective in unlocking political agreement among the Member State capitals.

More specifically, the report should:

- Highlight the technical viability of EU new own resources (NOR) that are currently overlooked in policymaking
- Provide renewed analytical credibility and political visibility to these alternatives
- Help generate broader support around a shortlist of options that could realistically enter (or re-enter) the policy debate at EU level

SCOPE OF WORK

Building on previous research, the report should **assess a shortlist of 3 to 5 alternative options** for genuinely new own resources that go beyond the current Commission's proposal. For each selected option, the report should, at a minimum:

- Describe how the instrument would work in practice
- Present its policy rationale and relevance in the current institutional/political context
- Analyse its potential revenue-raising capacities and likely distributional effects across Member States
- Provide an explanation of why it could contribute to breaking the deadlock and an indication of next steps to advance its adoption
- Any other relevant analysis the author deems necessary

The report should also **underline the complementarity of the proposed instruments** with national legislation and national tax systems, highlighting where relevant that these instruments need not simply displace national revenue, but can be designed to create additional streams.

Finally, the report should specifically **explore the option of hybrid revenue use**, under which a revenue instrument could generate two streams, one flowing into the EU budget, the other flowing into national budgets. This part of the analysis should assess whether hybrid designs could improve political acceptability among Member States while still generating meaningful revenue at EU level. It should also examine how such models could be structured and communicated in a way that addresses concerns about sovereignty, fairness and national budgetary impacts.

The report should be suitable for circulation ahead of key political moments in the MFF and own resources debate. It should **combine immediate policy usefulness with medium-term shelf life**: it should support advocacy and policymaker engagement ahead of important upcoming meetings, while remaining relevant as the negotiations move into a more transactional phase in late 2026 and 2027.

INDICATIVE LIST OF INSTRUMENTS

The final list of instruments should be agreed with the selected author at the outset of the assignment. It is expected to consist of a selection of 3 to 5 options. Authors can draw from the following list. Please note that this list is only indicative, and that we are open to working with other options.

Some of these alternative instruments are already part of policy discussions, pushed by some Member States, and are technically sound, but currently lack broad support among Member States. The objective is to move them from limited backing to wider political endorsement at EU level:

- The extension of CBAM to aviation, including a possible “SAF BAM”
- An EU-wide airline ticket tax complementary to existing national taxes, or a premium aviation levy

Other alternative instruments have been consistently pushed by civil society at the EU level, and by the MFF Hub in particular. The objective is to assess their political viability and suggest designs that would increase their appeal:

- A permanent tax on fossil fuel company ownership and profits
- A tax targeting ultra-high-net-worth individuals
- A tax on crypto-assets or crypto-currencies
- A financial transaction tax or a lump-sum levy on financial activities

Authors are welcome to offer refinements to this list, provided the proposals remain aligned with the purpose of the assignment. **Proposals for resources applying to non-EU external actors** that can generate new revenue would be particularly interesting to explore.

EXPECTED OUTPUTS

A short inception note, setting out the proposed shortlist of instruments, the analytical framework and the methodology, the proposed structure of the report, and any suggested refinements to the scope.

A draft report, in English, tentatively in the range of 4 to 6 pages, excluding annexes

A final report, incorporating two rounds of comments.

Authors may separately price **optional additional input**, such as a policy summary.

Examples of previous reports published by Global Citizen can be found on [the website](#). A good example of what we are looking for is [this report](#)

TIMELINE

We are reviewing submissions on a rolling basis. However, an indicative timeline is as follows:

- **By 12 June 2026:** submission of quotes
- **By 16 July 2026: submission of the draft report**
- **03 to 14 August 2026:** feedback and revisions
- **By 28 August 2026: submission of the final report**
- **18-19 September:** Informal ECOFIN

We encourage bidders to indicate any proposed flexibility in their delivery plan:

- **Sequencing Adjustments:** Propose any adjustments to the project sequencing that would preserve quality and policy usefulness.
- **Scope Adjustments:** If the full scope cannot be delivered to a high standard within the available time and budget, propose a narrower scope or a phased approach, and clearly explain the trade-offs involved.

WHAT TO INCLUDE IN YOUR QUOTE

Submissions should include the following elements:

- **Author profile:** A brief CV or biography. Please indicate any previous publications or advisory work related to EU own resources, the Multiannual Financial Framework, or related topics.
- **Proposed approach and methodology:** A short description of how you would approach the analysis, including the analytical framework you would apply to assess the viability, revenue potential, and political feasibility of each instrument.
- **Budget:** A total fee (in EUR) for the full scope of work, covering the inception note, draft report, and final report incorporating two rounds of comments. If you wish to propose optional additional inputs (such as a policy summary), please price these separately.
- **Relevant work samples:** One or two examples of previous publications or reports relevant to the subject matter (links or attachments welcome).

CONTACT

Please send quotes and any questions to:

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Deadline for submission of quotes:

Friday 22 May 2026 at 23:59 Brussels Time

Annex / References

- Christensen, Maya, Mustafa Khalfan, Astrid Dahlbeck, Jennifer Hallum, and Nabil Maitland. "How to Increase Taxes on Fossil Fuel Profits." Oxfam International, December 2025. <https://policy-practice.oxfam.org/resources/how-to-increase-taxes-on-fossil-fuel-profits>.
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- European Parliament. "Mapping the Current Structure and Discovering the Potential of 'Other Revenue.'" Study for the Committee on Budgets (BUDG), December 2024. [https://www.europarl.europa.eu/RegData/etudes/STUD/2025/768313/BUDG_STU\(2025\)768313_EN.pdf](https://www.europarl.europa.eu/RegData/etudes/STUD/2025/768313/BUDG_STU(2025)768313_EN.pdf)
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- European Youth Forum. "Own Resources Decision – EU Council Power Mapping." 2026. <https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/16HUe5ryi7y1dJQmrhV39XkEHmot49PsfelMHsrWIhdQ>.
- MFF Hub. "Letter to Finance Ministers Ahead of ECOFIN." June 2025. <https://www.mffhub.org/resources/letter-to-finance-ministers-ahead-of-ecofin>.
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- Schratzenstaller, Margit. "Own Resources for the Future: Critical Review & Opportunities." Presentation to the European Parliament BUDG hearing, WIFO, January 28, 2026. https://drive.google.com/file/d/12JZXybWdqKE27MludofIPbuy71QmNliY/view?usp=drive_link
- Schratzenstaller, Margit, Jakob Heimberger, Silvia Kubeková, and Antonio Sanz. "Other Revenue for the EU Budget: Status Quo and Potential." *Intereconomics*, 2025.
- Solilova, Veronika. "Proposed Own Resources for the Future: The CORE and Its Critical Review." Presentation, 2025. https://drive.google.com/file/d/1C6GAHuVX2osknISf4ME8In3j7HOkx50z/view?usp=drive_link
- Thomadakis, Apostolos. "A Common EU Digital Tax." Presentation at the European Parliament BUDG hearing, CEPS, January 28, 2026. https://drive.google.com/file/d/1DuEJ-d2_jCp8UZe2WPzJHZU1-CBiNdBQ/view?usp=drive_link